OASIS REVENUE LAB

Sterling / Downtown 2BR Rent Decision

Prepared for Shajidah / Wellspring Vacation Homes LLC
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Client-ready | August lease decision | Business Bay + Downtown

Main Verdict

Sterling is performing OK. AED 180k/year is not a failure signal; it is a forward-looking margin and opportunity decision.

Recommended Action

Landlord will not renegotiate. Keep if the unit's performance and view justify the rent; move only for a better-value comparable.

Target Search

Best replacement band: AED 150k-165k if furniture can be reused. AED 165k-170k is acceptable only for better view/building quality.

Winter Risk

Dubai should still book, but do not assume last year's peak pricing repeats. Protect fixed-rent margin before August.

Note: captcha-blocked portal pages were not used as client-facing proof links.

1. Executive View

Sterling is under control. The decision is whether the current apartment should keep carrying AED 180k fixed rent before winter.

Bottom Line

Sterling should be presented as under control from a revenue-management point of view. The June/July report shows the unit is performing OK for the period and the market situation. AED 180,000/year can be fair for The Sterling if the apartment is large, high floor, clean, guest-ready and has a clear Burj Khalifa, Downtown or canal view, but it is still a high fixed-rent commitment.

Decision

- Because the landlord will not renegotiate, treat AED 180,000 as a stay-or-move decision, not a negotiation target.
- Frame any move as a way to improve fixed-rent margin or upgrade the revenue opportunity.
- Move only if a comparable/better-view 2BR is found around AED 150,000-165,000, or around AED 170,000 with clear revenue upside.
- Do not move for only AED 5,000-10,000 saving because commission, deposit, moving, setup, new photos and downtime can erase the benefit.
- Keep AED 180,000 only if the current unit is clearly stronger than the alternatives and avoids August transition risk.

Revenue-Market Read

If geopolitical tension eases, winter demand should improve. If it does not fully ease, Dubai should still get booked, but likely with softer rate power than the exceptional winters of the last two to three years. The practical risk is lower margin, not necessarily loss, so rent discipline matters.

2. Sterling Performance Context

The current unit should be described as managed and performing OK, not as a problem asset.

What The June Report Shows

- The Wellspring June report shows the Sterling / Luxury 2BR Downtown unit as a newer listing, so there is no clean same-unit June 2025 comparison.
- June 2026 revenue is around AED 12.8k, which is acceptable for the period and market situation.
- July forward occupancy is around 81%, above the Dubai market reference near 46% and ahead of the other shown Wellspring units.
- ADR is acceptable for the current situation; the issue is not that revenue management has lost control.
- The lease decision should be based on fixed-rent margin, winter risk, move cost and alternative opportunity quality.

Client Framing

The correct client message is: Sterling has performed OK and is under revenue-management control. The decision is whether staying at AED 180k gives enough margin and upside compared with moving furniture into a better-value 2BR with similar or better guest appeal.

3. Sterling Rent Position

Sterling pricing depends heavily on size, view, floor and furnishing quality.

Sterling 2BR Type	Sensible Rent Band	Interpretation
Smaller / ordinary view / unfurnished	AED 145k-155k	Good target if moving furniture into the unit.
Smaller but good view / clean finish	AED 155k-170k	Strong replacement range if photos and layout are good.
Larger 1,650-1,700 sqft / good layout	AED 165k-180k	AED 180k becomes defensible here.
Premium furnished / high floor / strong Burj view	AED 180k-200k	Pay only if expected ADR uplift is clear.

Interpretation

A 1,100-1,150 sqft 2BR at AED 180k is expensive unless the view and furnishing are excellent. A 1,650-1,700 sqft unit at the same rent is much easier to defend. This is why Shajidah should compare exact unit quality, not only tower name.

4. Sterling Market Evidence

Keep the real price context: the AED 180k decision depends on size, view and exact unit quality.

The Sterling East Active Listing Signal

Property Finder showed an active 2BR listing in The Sterling East at AED 190,000/year. This is useful as an upper benchmark, not as the target price.

- 2 bedrooms, 3 bathrooms.
- 1,123 sqft.
- Fully furnished.
- High floor.
- Burj Khalifa view.
- Available from 5 June 2026.

Price Insight

Property Finder price insight showed this AED 190k listing as 14% above the listed average, with average rent shown around AED 166,919. That confirms AED 190k is top-end for a smaller furnished high-view 2BR, while AED 180k needs strong unit quality to be justified.

Question	Answer	Meaning
Is AED 190k normal?	No, it is an upper benchmark.	Useful only for premium view/furnishing reference.
Is AED 180k impossible?	No.	It can be fair for larger or clearly superior stock.
Is AED 155k-170k realistic?	Yes.	This is the strongest replacement-search band.

5. Sterling Transaction And Portal Signals

The transaction list is the most useful context for why size matters.

Date	Rent	Size	Interpretation
16 Jul 2026	AED 170,000	1,690 sqft	Large-unit benchmark below AED 180k.
23 Jun 2026	AED 155,000	1,123 sqft	Smaller-unit evidence near the lower band.
11 May 2026	AED 200,000	1,665 sqft	Premium transaction, likely quality/view led.
8 May 2026	AED 180,000	1,690 sqft	Shows AED 180k can be fair for larger Sterling stock.
10 Mar 2026	AED 180,000	1,684 sqft	Supports AED 180k only when size/quality are strong.

Transaction Read

This transaction set suggests AED 180,000 can be fair for a larger 1,680-1,690 sqft 2BR, while a smaller 1,123 sqft unit should usually sit closer to AED 155,000 unless the view, floor, furnishing and guest appeal are exceptional.

Bayut And Portal Search Evidence

- The Sterling East 2BR average signal around AED 176,113.
- The Sterling West 2BR average signal around AED 176,368.
- The Sterling overall 2BR average signal around AED 183,438.
- Sterling West 2BR listings seen between about AED 159,880 and AED 175,000.

Furnished 2BR with Burj Khalifa view signal around AED 160,000/year for 1,123 sqft.

- Spacious 2BR Business Bay signal around AED 150,000/year for 1,690 sqft.

Bayut pages were partly blocked by captcha during direct fetch, so these points should be treated as listing-search evidence and price-context signals, not final transaction proof.

6. Business Bay Alternatives

Compare The Sterling against nearby Business Bay stock before accepting AED 180k as normal.

Tower / Area	2BR Rent Signal	Why It Matters	Decision Context
The Sterling East / West	AED 155k-190k	Current benchmark	AED 180k is defensible only with strong view, size, floor and condition.
Peninsula / Business Bay	AED 160k-190k+	Newer canal/Downtown stock	Strong alternative if view is good and the finish photographs better.
Executive Towers / older Business Bay	AED 140k-170k	Value reference	Can save rent, but quality/view must be checked carefully for STR appeal.
Residence 22 / Jumeirah Living style premium stock	AED 220k+	Luxury benchmark	Usually too expensive for this margin-protection decision.

Practical Filter

- Shortlist Business Bay options only if the view is at least comparable to the current Sterling unit.
- Prioritise AED 150k-165k where Shajidah can move existing furniture cleanly.
- Reject cheaper apartments that save rent but weaken photos or guest appeal.

7. Downtown Comparables

Downtown options can help with positioning, but premium Burj/Fountain rent can destroy margin.

Tower / Area	2BR Rent Signal	Guest Appeal	Decision Context
Burj Views / Downtown	AED 145k-175k	Practical Downtown access	Good value check against Sterling if condition and view are clean.
South Ridge / Downtown	AED 160k-190k	Strong Downtown family/ guest location	Worth viewing if size, layout and view justify the rent.
Downtown Views II	AED 160k-200k	Newer mall/Downtown positioning	Good replacement only if view creates real revenue upside.
Burj Royale / central Downtown newer stock	AED 170k-220k+	Tourist-friendly when view is strong	Consider only if the rent is disciplined and forecast supports it.
Core Burj/Fountain-view units	AED 240k+	Iconic premium view	Usually not sensible for cost control unless premium ADR is proven.

Downtown Read

Downtown can improve guest demand and pricing power, but only when the rent stays controlled. A better address is not enough if the fixed rent removes the margin.

8. Furniture-Move Strategy

Furniture is leverage only if the new apartment photographs well and avoids heavy setup friction.

Best Search Brief

- 2BR, preferably 1,300 sqft or above.
- Unfurnished or lightly furnished if existing furniture fits the layout.
- View priority: Burj Khalifa, Downtown skyline, canal, or open view.
- Target rent: AED 150,000-165,000.
- Stretch rent: AED 165,000-170,000 if the view/building is clearly better.
- Avoid AED 180,000 for a smaller unit unless the revenue case is clearly stronger than the current apartment.

When Moving Works

Moving works if Shajidah gets a similar or stronger guest proposition at meaningfully lower fixed rent. It does not work if the new unit has weaker view, weaker photos, awkward layout, more maintenance, or August downtime that damages revenue.

Hidden Costs

- Agent commission and deposit.
- Moving labour and furniture damage risk.
- Minor maintenance or setup work.
- New photos, listing edits and possible ranking/availability disruption.
- Transition downtime during August.

9. Winter And Revenue Risk

The right answer protects margin without assuming a disaster scenario.

Market Assumption

Dubai should still book in winter. The question is rate strength. If regional tension eases, confidence and travel demand should improve. If it does not fully ease, bookings should still come, but rate power may sit below the very strong prior winters.

Revenue Posture

- Treat AED 180,000 as the rent ceiling, not the target.
- Protect fixed-rent margin before winter.
- Do not chase the cheapest unit if the view, building or guest appeal becomes weaker.
- Do not overpay for a premium view unless the expected ADR uplift is believable.
- Assume a workable winter, not necessarily a record winter.

Practical Meaning

A good apartment at controlled rent can still perform well even if ADR is softer. A mediocre apartment at top-end rent becomes fragile because the operator needs very strong nightly rates just to protect margin.

10. August Decision Rule

Use this before deciding whether to leave the current apartment.

Outcome	Recommendation
Current rent stays at AED 180k	Stay only if the unit is genuinely strong: size, view, floor, condition and low transition risk.
Comparable unit found at AED 150k-165k	Move is worth serious review.
New unit saves only AED 5k-10k	Usually not worth moving.
New unit saves AED 20k-30k and quality is similar	Move is likely worth it.
New unit costs AED 170k-180k but has much better view	Consider only after revenue forecast.
New unit has weaker view/location	Avoid unless saving is substantial.

Decision Position

Because renegotiation is not available, AED 180k should be treated as the cost of staying. Staying is valid only if the current apartment is clearly stronger than realistic alternatives.

11. Message To Shajidah

Client wording Damiano can send or adapt.

Shajidah, I checked the current Sterling, Business Bay and nearby Downtown 2BR market together with the latest Wellspring performance context. The Sterling unit has performed OK for the period, and the July forward occupancy signal is strong, so the decision is strategic rather than reactive.

My honest view is that AED 180k is a high fixed-rent commitment, but it can still make sense if the current apartment is large, has a strong Burj/Downtown/canal view, photographs well and avoids moving friction. If we can find a comparable or better 2BR where you can reuse your furniture around AED 150k-165k, or a very good option around AED 170k, it is worth considering before August.

For winter, I still expect Dubai to get booked, especially if regional tension eases. But I would not assume the same strong pricing as the last two to three winters. Since the landlord will not renegotiate, the decision is simple: stay if Sterling's quality and performance justify AED 180k, or move only if the saving or view/revenue upside is meaningful.

12. Final Recommendation

The clean operating plan for the next 7-10 days.

- Accept that the current lease stays at AED 180k unless Shajidah leaves.
- Use the Wellspring report to show the unit performed OK and the July forward occupancy signal is strong.
- Search actively for Sterling, Burj Views, South Ridge, Downtown Views II and selected Peninsula 2BRs with good view.
- Shortlist only units that save AED 20k-30k/year or materially improve revenue potential.
- Reject weaker-view units unless the saving is substantial.
- Make the August decision from exact unit details: size, view, floor, condition, rent, payment terms, move cost and downtime.

Bottom Line

Do not move emotionally and do not overpay defensively. If the market gives Shajidah a cleaner 2BR around AED 150k-165k, moving furniture can be smart. If the best alternatives are only slightly cheaper or weaker, staying at AED 180k may still be the cleaner decision.

Sources And Limitations

Sources reviewed included Property Finder listing/search signals for The Sterling and Downtown/Business Bay 2BRs, Dubizzle listing snippets, Propsearch Downtown Views II rental evidence, and broader public portal snippets. Some direct portal pages were captcha-blocked, so blocked pages are not used as client-facing links or standalone proof. This is a market and revenue-management decision note, not a valuation certificate.